Not quite ready to rumble? Then step into the Octagon with **Randy Couture, Rich Franklin,** and **Chuck Liddell.** With these three UFC warrior-scholars on offense (and man-beast **Jason Lambert** on D), you'll be a seasoned bruiser in no time.

Fight like a Man!

Randy Couture
Stats: 6'2", 220 lbs.
MMA record: 15-8-0
Fight specialty: Takedowns

Rich Franklin
Stats: 6'1", 185 lbs.
MMA record: 23-2-0
Fight specialty: Kicking

Chuck Liddell
Stats: 6'2", 205 lbs.
MMA record: 20-4-0
Fight specialty: Striking

Jason Lambert
Stats: 5'10", 205 lbs.
MMA record: 23-6-0
Fight specialty: Submissions

Overhand Right to Double-Hand Takedown

Randy Couture shows you how to use the cold, hard earth to your advantage.

"The Natural" knows full well that when a fight goes to the ground, it's better to be the guy doing the slamming. "Until you learn how to throw somebody down, you can't take advantage of your grappling skills," he explains. "It's one of the areas where people tend to struggle." True—people like your little brother, his punk-ass friends, and *you* if you don't pay attention to this takedown specialist's superior technique.

1 **Punch:** First, throw a strike to make him cover up and expose his midsection. "Always strike hard, even if you're just setting up a takedown," notes Couture.

2 **Weave:** You need to penetrate quickly or he'll block your approach, so do a quick "level change" by bending your knees and weaving your head under his armpit.

By **Jeff Foss** Photographs by **Kai Regan**

LAMBERT ALERT!

How to thwart a vicious takedown

"The key is keeping him from penetrating," explains Lambert. "As he dives in, sprawl your legs back behind you and drive down on top of him with your chest."

PUNISHING POINTS

Please Hold

A takedown made easy.

3 **Hands:** Get a firm grip on the backs of his knees, but don't worry about lifting him off the ground. "Focus on moving him laterally, not flipping him over on his back."

4 **Footwork:** Once you've got a good hold, take short, choppy steps across your opponent's stance to keep him off balance and unsure of where you're going.

5 **Eyes:** Your head and upper body will follow your eyes, so look across the back of your opponent in the direction you want his body to go: sideways and down.

6 **Slam:** Spike your forward shoulder directly into your opponent's midsection as he crashes headlong into the ground, readying him for pummeling and/or spit drips.

Hamstring Helper
Grabbing your opponent by the backs of his legs will prevent him from sprawling them backward to counter your momentum.

Head Over Heels
Using your head, drive his lower body over his upper body, steering him where you want. "Your head's like a third arm," says Couture.

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Left Hook to the Body

Chuck Liddell gives you a bruisin' on the inside.

If you're lucky, you'll never receive a strike to the liver. "It's like your brain wants to keep fighting, but your body wants to shut down," says the UFC champ. To exploit this vulnerable organ on the body's right side, try Liddell's infamous left hook. "It's the kind of punch that can slow someone down or even end a fight," he notes. "I don't think guys use it enough."

LAMBERT ALERT!

How to absorb a brutal body shot

"Keep your hands high but bend your legs, drop your elbow, and crunch your body to the side," says Lambert. "This means everything is protected."

1. **Feet:** Position yourself in a "ready stance" with your knees slightly bent and most (but not all) of your weight on the balls of your feet.
2. **Eyes:** "This strike can get your opponent to drop his hands, opening him up for face shots," says Liddell. Don't stare at any one strike target.
3. **Hips:** If you blindly helicopter your arm around, you'll probably miss. Instead, initiate the blow with your hips. "The power comes from the twist."
4. **Arm:** Lock your hand and forearm into one powerful unit. "When I throw the hook, I think of my arm as a whip with a rock attached to the end."
5. **Knuckles:** Make contact with the first two knuckles of your fist; the other two are fragile and prone to injury (like dog-fighting poodles).
6. **Follow-through:** Swing *through* your opponent, not just up until the point where contact is made. "With this hook, it's like I'm swinging a bat."

PUNISHING POINTS

Focus Your Fists of Fury

Because Lucky Strike is a brand of cigarettes, not a punching strategy.

Chin
"This is the knockout punch I'm looking for," says Liddell. "Ideally, I want to get him right behind the chin to make his head snap around."

Temple
"I'll take what I can get when I go high with a hook, but the side of the head makes a big target, especially if his hands are down."

Ribs
"Aim for just below his floating ribs. If you get him good and hard right here in the liver, you'll be amazed how fast he drops."

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LAMBERT ALERT!

How to block a crushing leg kick

"If you drop your hands to block, his next kick will target your chin," warns Lambert. "Instead, drive your foot into the ground, flex forward, and throw a punch."

Outside Leg Kick

Rich Franklin: foot-in-mouth expert.

This jujitsu devotee sees his legs as powerful long-range missiles that give opponents new and painful angles to consider. But before you shatter your tailbone attempting a Van Damme–style roundhouse, try a simple kick. "It's like a jab or hand combination in boxing," says Franklin. "It won't end a fight, but it pays off over time."

1. **Fist:** First you'll need to throw a hand combo to get him to react. As soon as this happens, it's open kicking season on anything he isn't covering.
2. **Eyes:** Instead of looking where you're kicking, focus on the little dimple just under his Adam's apple. "Read his entire movement," says Franklin.
3. **Feet:** To "chamber" your kick, step wide with your lead leg at a 45-degree angle so that you're standing outside your opponent's stance.
4. **Hips:** Roll your hips toward your opponent to initiate the swing, allowing your shoulders to follow. Use this same motion wherever you're aiming.
5. **Body:** "Your body will naturally lean away from your opponent as you kick," notes Franklin. "This helps protect you from a counterattack."
6. **Shins:** Make contact with the bottom two inches of your shin, just above your ankle. "Don't use the top of your foot or you'll risk an injury."

PUNISHING POINTS

Shin-Blade Weapon

Your chicken legs can do serious damage if you know where to aim.

Quads
"Aim for the area directly between the knee and groin," advises Franklin. "This is where the muscle splits, so it's an especially vulnerable spot."

Ribs
"You want to rattle those organs just behind his floating ribs. Unlike in boxing, one good, solid kick to this area can end a fight."

Chin
Don't be picky with your high kicks. "Anything to the head can do some real damage." That said, square on the chin is your best TKO target.

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